

**PLEASE READ EVERY WORD OF THIS DOCUMENT.
YOU ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR KNOWING THE CONTENTS.**

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Meetings

Lecture

Day, time, location: Tuesdays and Thursdays, 12:30pm-1:50pm, ELH 100

Lecturer: Aaron Bornstein (he/him)

Office hours: On Zoom, by appointment.

Appointment sign-up link: <https://tinyurl.com/aaronb-140m-officehours>

Appointments can be made with at least 3 hours notice,
12pm-5pm Monday through Friday

Zoom link: <https://tinyurl.com/aaronbzoom>

All lecture recordings will be posted to Canvas within 24 hours after class.

All slides will be posted to Canvas at least one day before the lecture.

Quiz question banks will be posted at the start of each 4-lecture “unit.”

Teaching assistants (assigned by student’s last name):

Students named Acosta-Reyes through Jaeger: Alexa Booras (she/her)

Office hours: On Zoom, by appointment.

Appointment sign-up link:

<https://calendar.app.google/3RvVTTQ96ma1n8Ks8>

Zoom link:

<https://uci.zoom.us/j/4336136299>

Jeon through Pour-Madjid: Yunke Chen (she/her)

Office hours: On Zoom, by appointment.

Appointment sign-up link:

<https://calendar.app.google/d6Xu8JQCfP76W9mJ9>

(Appointments can be made with at least 3 hours notice.)

Zoom link:

<https://uci.zoom.us/j/78581677895?pwd=Up6JP6GxcpiyzW66Rlix7zVEYeJj0>

[b.1](#)

Preciado through Zwibel: Em Smullen (they/them)

Office hours: On Zoom, by appointment.

Appointment sign-up link: <https://tinyurl.com/emofficehrcal>

Zoom link: <https://tinyurl.com/emsmullenzoom>

Communication

I strongly encourage you to *regularly* communicate with the instructors and your classmates about the course material. Building a routine of talking about the class will help you remember the material we cover.

Here are some options for discussing your questions and comments:

1. **Use the Canvas Discussion board.** In a 300 person class, if you have a question it is nearly certain that other people have similar questions to yours. Post your question here, and either one of your classmates or the instructors will get back to you ASAP. This will have the added benefit of answering the question for everyone else.
2. **Come to office hours.** For longer discussions about the course material, I encourage everyone to talk to the instructors early and often. If the office hour times don't work for you, send an email and we can work something out. Given the size of the course, I encourage you to reach out to your assigned teaching assistant **first**, and then follow up with me only afterwards.

Course contents

The goal of this course is for you to become familiar with the scientific study of the phenomenon we call "memory." We will cover the contemporary frameworks for subdividing types of memory, the methods that researchers use to study memory in action, and the questions that are occupying current research.

Books

You are **not** required to buy any books. Readings will consist of papers, articles, and book chapters posted online.

Course structure

Grading

The course will be divided into four units of four lectures each; each unit spans two weeks of course material. Your grade will be based on three quizzes and one final exam. (We will discuss how this approach of frequent testing reflects the memory research.) The quizzes will cover the material of the previous unit (e.g., the first quiz will be during Week 3 and covers materials from Weeks 1-3). The final exam will cover the entire course, but more heavily focus on the material covered in the last unit (Weeks 9 & 10). At the beginning of each unit, I will post a bank of quiz questions (without answers) to Canvas. The answers to the quiz questions will be contained within the lectures and required reading materials for that unit. (Quiz answers will not depend on optional readings, except for the portions of those readings that are repeated in required readings or lectures.) The quizzes will be a selection of some, but *not all*, of the questions posted in the question bank. The final exam will consist partly of questions from the previous question banks that were not already asked, as well as selections from a bank of new questions, which will be posted at the beginning of the last unit.

- 60%: Three quizzes, 20% each.
 - Each quiz will consist of 15 multiple-choice questions, and five short-answer questions.
 - We will **not** be dropping the lowest quiz.
- 40%: Final exam.
 - The final exam will consist of 55 multiple-choice questions, and five short-answer questions.

All quizzes will be taken via Canvas, using the RespondUs browser, and will be available online **until 5pm the day after the scheduled lecture time**. In other words, a Quiz scheduled for a Tuesday will be available from 12:30pm Tuesday to 5pm Wednesday. I recommend just doing the Quiz during normal lecture time, however I allow for different times to accommodate individual schedules or unforeseen events. Once you begin the Quiz, you will have three hours to complete it—I expect the Quizzes to require well under an hour to complete, but I allow extra time to account for all individual situations. Question and multiple-choice answer order will be randomized for each person. **Please follow UCI policies on academic integrity.**

Do NOT skip a quiz. We will NOT drop the lowest Quiz. If you miss a Quiz you will receive a zero grade, and thus be in serious danger of failing the course.

If you believe that you will not be able to finish the Quiz within the allotted day and a half time window, please let Professor Bornstein know DIRECTLY and IMMEDIATELY.

The Final Exam: Will be available online all of Finals week (Mon 8am - Fri 5pm). Please try and get it done as soon as you can - I cannot grant any extensions without giving you an Incomplete grade in the class. The Final will largely ($\frac{1}{3}$ to $\frac{1}{2}$ of questions) cover Unit 4. The rest will be from questions in the question banks for Units 1-3 that were not asked on Quiz 1-3.

Grade Cut-Offs: Letter-grade cut-offs are the UCI standard: A+ 100 % to 96.5% A < 96.5 % to 93.5% A- < 93.5 % to 90.0% B+ < 90.0 % to 86.5% B < 86.5 % to 83.5% B- < 83.5 % to 80.0% C+ < 80.0 % to 76.5% C < 76.5 % to 73.5% C- < 73.5 % to 70.0% D+ < 70.0 % to 66.5% D < 66.5 % to 63.5% D- < 63.5 % to 60.0% F < 60.0 % to 0.0%.

For those taking the class P/NP: A Pass will be a 73.5% or above (at least a C grade)

Grading Errors: Errors in calculations or answers can occur and we will take steps to correct them if you point them out. If you believe there is an *error* in your grading (e.g., a miscalculation, an improperly answered question; **NOT** a difference of opinion about what your grade *should* be), you should contact your teaching assistant right away so we can adjust your grade in the books. Do not wait to point these out - it is easier for us to correct these if you tell us right away.

Course policies

Plagiarism and Academic Integrity: All student work must be your own original work. You may not distribute exam materials to anyone. Learning, research, and scholarship depend upon an environment of academic integrity and honesty. This environment can be maintained only when all participants recognize the importance of upholding the highest ethical standards. Academic dishonesty includes, for example, cheating on examinations or any assignment, plagiarism of any kind (including improper citation of sources), having someone else take an examination or complete an assignment for you (or doing this for someone else), or any activity in which you represent someone else's work as your own. Violations of academic integrity will be referred to the Office of Academic Integrity and Student Conduct. If you are determined to have committed plagiarism, your grade for the **entire** corresponding quiz will be **zero**. Please familiarize yourself with UCI's Academic Integrity Policy (<https://conduct.uci.edu/academic-integrity/>) and speak to your instructors if you have any questions about what is and is not allowed in this course.

Policy on machine-generated content ("artificial intelligence"): Use of any

software tools that generate natural-language text in response to natural language prompts is considered to be plagiarism, and subject to the policy and penalty described above.

Disability Accommodations: If you require special accommodations or have a disability you would like me to be aware of, please be in touch with the UCI Disabilities Services at the *beginning* of the course. However, note that the Quiz time is already *much* longer than needed, and all lectures are already recorded. In other words, there is not likely to be any need for additional accommodations.

Relationship between this course and current political context: Science is always part of a social context and this context is sometimes directly relevant to the concepts in class or the pedagogical principles of the course. For example, issues of misinformation connects to research on false memory, questions about the transmission of cultural memory to our discussions of social learning, and past and present attempts to extinguish even the memories of populations or events via physical dispersion, the destruction of artifacts, and the censorship of language relate to our courselong theme on the impossibility of completely erasing episodic memory. As such, in this course your instructors reserve the right to discuss historical and current events shaping this course and its content.

Schedule

The following schedule gives the topics for each lecture. Note that this schedule is subject to change as the quarter progresses. I will do my best to notify you about substantive changes well in advance.

Week	Day	Date	Topic
1	Tu	03/31/2026	Lecture 0: Introduction/course overview - What and why is memory?
		Reading	Syllabus
		Reading	"How to read a paper"
	Th	04/02/2026	Lecture 1: Experimental methods & Neuroanatomy (Recorded)
		Reading	Lombrozo (2013)
		Suggested reading	Tolman (1948)
2	Tu	04/07/2026	Lecture 2: Working memory
		Reading	Baddeley - Working memory: Looking back and looking forward (2003)
		Suggested reading	Luck & Vogel 2013
	Th	04/09/2026	Lecture 3: Episodic memory, part 1
		Reading	Tulving (1972)

3	Tu	04/14/2026	Lecture 4: Episodic memory, part 2
		Reading	Squire (2004)
	Th	04/16/2026	Quiz 1: Lectures 1-4
4	Tu	04/21/2026	Lecture 5: Semantic memory
		Reading	Yee et al (2013)
		Suggested reading	Penguins (SciAm)
		Suggested reading	Withthoft and Winawer (2012)
	Th	04/23/2026	Lecture 6: Skill learning
		Reading	Dayan & Cohen (2011)
5	Tu	04/28/2026	Lecture 7: Habitization
		Reading	Graybiel (2008)
		Suggested reading	Federer - Wallace
	Th	04/30/2026	Lecture 8: Conditioning
		Reading	Conditioning & Learning (Noba)
6	Tu	05/05/2026	Quiz 2: Lectures 5-8
	Th	05/07/2026	Lecture 9: Cognitive control
		Reading	Levy & Anderson (2002)
		Suggested reading	Simons & Spiers (2003)
7	Tu	05/12/2026	Lecture 10: Forgetting
		Reading	Schacter (1999)
	Th	05/14/2026	Lecture 11: Distortion and false memories
		Reading	Loftus (2003)
8	Tu	05/19/2026	Lecture 12: Emotional memories
		Reading	Phelps (2004)
	Th	05/21/2026	Quiz 3: Lectures 9-12
9	Tu	05/26/2026	Lecture 13: TBD
		Reading	TBD
	Th	05/28/2026	Lecture 14: TBD
		Reading	TBD
10	Tu	06/02/2026	Lecture 15: TBD
		Reading	TBD

	Th	06/04/2026	Lecture 16: TBD
		Reading	TBD